post-modernists.’[238] In fact, Taylor believes that the current post-modern trends are not only secular and alien to religious understanding of the world, but also anti-humanist, putting the basic values of our (European or Western) civilisation under threat in a way that is difficult to withstand: ‘And the farther one moves to a “post-modern”, “anti-humanist” position, the more a passionate commitment to universal rights is without grounding in the nature of things, and without hope of reward or fulfilment, the more unmotivated in traditional terms this commitment is, as with Derrida for instance, then the more it is plainly powered by a sense of dignity, the sense of a demand laid on us by our very lucidity. This seems admirable and heroic. And in a way undoubtedly is. But a question arises of whether it is an adequate source, that is, whether it can really motivate us to carry through on our aspiration to universal human dignity and well-being.’[239] He is concerned about what he terms as ‘exclusive humanism’ (by which he means a humanism devoid of any transcendence), because this new type of humanism demands that ‘you can’t be fully into contemporary humanist concerns if you haven’t sloughed off the old beliefs. You can’t be fully with the modern age and still believe in God’.[240]

But he too is not convinced by those that ‘look back and see the glorious past of Christendom, be it in the European Middle Ages, or in the early modern period, or in the time before the French Revolution, or before the Reformation; or even, as with the American “Christian Right”, the age they want to restore is only a few decades in the past’.[241] What he calls for is another type of Christianity that is not hostile to liberalism at all – but also rejects the ‘secular fundamentalism’ of what he calls ‘polite society’, antagonistic to Christianity.

The same issue occupies the mind of the Czech philosopher and Templeton Prize recipient Tomáš Halík. He rejects both the ‘naively militant “new atheism” of Richard Dawkins and Co. and, on the other hand, its equally noisy and similarly naive counterparts: Christian fundamentalism and the “religious Right”.’[242] Instead, in his view, the future of our Western civilisation ‘depends on the capacity of two types of humanism to coexist and be mutually compatible, namely Christian humanism and secular humanism’.[243] This is because ‘were Christianity to turn its back on modernity it would sink into bigotry and fundamentalist religion, and conversely, were modernity to turn away completely from